

Therapy Approaches

The Cycles Approach

When your speech and language therapist creates a therapy plan, there are different approaches that they can choose. There is no single intervention approach that works for every child and sometimes this may need to be changed. Based on current research and evidence based practice, your speech and language therapist will aim to select the right intervention to meet the needs of the child.

What is the cycles approach?

In therapy sessions we cycle through words each week

The Cycles Approach

The cycles approach is useful for children who present with lots of speech sound errors. It works on specific speech error patterns called 'phonological processes'. In therapy, five 'phonological processes' are selected and the child 'cycles' through these. Each process is worked on for an hour, and then the next sound within that process or a new error pattern is targeted. These are worked on initially at word level and are cycled through again within phrases and sentences, until the errors are no longer apparent in their speech.

What happens in therapy?

- Firstly, your therapist will plan out what 'phonological processes' they will target. There will usually be five in total. This is a cycle.
- The therapy session will begin with a listening task. The therapist reads a list of carefully chosen words that relate to the phonological process or error pattern being targeted.
- Five target words are chosen for the production activity, picture cards will be provided for these (or you can draw them). Fun and engaging activities will be played to encourage multiple repetitions of these words.
- At the end of each session your child will listen to the therapist read out the same list of words that was used at the start of the session.
- When the whole cycle is completed, the therapist will re-assess the child's speech to decide on next steps.

EXAMPLE

A child presents with the following phonological processes:

- Fronting of /k/ and /g/
- /s/ cluster reduction /sn/ /sp/
- Final consonant deletion of /d/ and /t/

SAMPLE CYCLES LIST

Fronting	Fronting	Clusters	Clusters	FCD
/k/	/g/	/sn/	/sp/	/t/
cat	go	snail	spider	wet
cap	good	snore	spoon	hat
car	gum	snake	space	boat
key	game	snow	spy	out
cow	guy	sniff	spill	eight

